



The Future of Healthcare is in Learning from Each Other

Medicine continues to evolve as patients are more informed than ever, and they actively seek information and ask questions about treatment options

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IN THE 1960s, I graduated from King George's Medical University in Lucknow and soon afterwards, left for the United States to pursue my surgical training. These were some of the most demanding years of my life—the standards were uncompromising, excellence was never negotiable, and every clinical decision was anchored in evidence, precision and an unwavering commitment to patient safety.

I always knew that I would return to India, but when I finally moved back after nearly two decades in the US, the contrast between the two healthcare systems was striking.

In the US, patients experience long waiting periods before they can consult specialists or undergo elective procedures. These systems provide comprehensive care, but demand almost always exceeds capacity. In India, the challenge is different—many urban patients can get access to specialists relatively quickly, but in rural areas, affordability and geographical reach limit access.

While both models present different challenges, my experiences in medicine made me realise that both countries should learn from each other to ensure timely, accessible, equitable and high-quality care.

For much of the last century, and even into the early years of this one, Western healthcare systems, especially in the US, set the global benchmark for clinical excellence. Their emphasis on standardised protocols, multidisciplinary collaboration, rigorous research and evidence-based practice has consistently improved patient outcomes, significantly advancing modern medicine.

India has charted an equally compelling journey. Over the past few decades, our country has demonstrated how high-quality healthcare can be delivered at scale by combining clinical excellence with innovation, cost efficiency and the rapid adoption of technology.

Today, I believe the gap between India's leading hospitals and the best

institutions globally has narrowed significantly. Medanta has been featured among the world's best hospitals for seven consecutive years. Hundreds of thousands of patients from across the world now seek treatment in India because of the quality of care available here.

Having said that, medicine continues to evolve. Patients are more informed than ever, and with vast amounts of information—both accurate and inaccurate—available online, they actively seek information, ask questions about the treatment options available, and the potential risks and the likely outcomes.

Which is why experience and expertise remain crucial to any clinical decision-making—medical decisions demand practical knowledge, judgement and careful balancing of risks and benefits.

And this is one of the areas where India faces one of its most pressing challenges—our healthcare workforce. As our population grows



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